

— BRAND PLATFORM · V1.0 · WORKING NAME PENDING

A formula that belongs to *one person.*

The identity work for the perfume house founded by Anna Esen and Françoise Rapp, conducted under The Collapse, the method used at Quantum Branding. Built from the working session of 18 September 2026, ninety-six minutes, three exercises.

PREPARED FOR

Anna Esen
Françoise Rapp

METHOD

The Collapse
BrandOS

DATE

18 September 2026

STATUS

Bedrock drafted
Name open

What this document is, and *what it is not yet*.

Everything here traces back to a sentence one of you said on 18 September, or to a word one of you refused. Where it does not, the page says so and marks the claim as a proposal waiting on your answer.

What this is

The brand platform. The part that stops moving. Reason for being, beliefs, promise, positioning, five values, voice, visual direction, and the frame the offer sits inside.

It is written to be argued with. A platform nobody pushed back on is a platform nobody read. Section V closes with the decisions that are still yours to make.

Three kinds of statement

SETTLED	Both founders said it, or agreed to it, inside the session. It is quoted.
DERIVED	Follows from what you said, by an argument printed on the page. Challenge the argument, not the conclusion.
PROPOSED	Not covered in the session. Marked PROPOSAL . Yours to accept or replace.

What the session did not reach

Ninety-six minutes covered three of the five parts of the brand anatomy. The recording available for this work runs to the sixty-seventh minute. Four things are therefore open, and each is flagged where it belongs.

- 01 The fifth client adjective.** Four were agreed: influential, passionate, conscious, wealthy. The fifth was being discussed when the available record ends.
- 02 Tone of voice, as an exercise.** Section III proposes one, built from how you both talk, not from a word list you picked.
- 03 Look and feel, as an exercise.** Same treatment. Section III is a direction to react to, not a decision taken.
- 04 The name.** Never raised. Section IV opens it properly.

One reading rule

The perfume is the product. It is not the subject. That distinction was settled out loud at minute twenty-eight, and it governs every page after it. When you find yourself describing what the bottle contains, you have drifted. The subject is the person the bottle was read from.

The fragrance is the entry to the club, but the club is not the subject, it's the impact.

NIZZAR BEN CHEKROUNE, AGREED BY BOTH FOUNDERS • 00:28:14

Two documents, one day

This platform is the authority on identity: who sells, in what voice, refusing what.

A commercial frame covering price, formulas, production capacity and terms does not exist yet. When it does, identity questions settle here and commercial detail settles there.

No trademark search has been run. Page 39 says so again, in the place where it matters.

What is inside *this document*.

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The Collapse. *Observe, Collapse, Build, Hold.*

A brand is not decided. It is collapsed out of everything the founders already carry, by putting them under enough pressure that only the load-bearing answers survive.

01

Observe

Gather without editing. Exercises, not interviews. The founders talk, the strategist watches for the sentence that was not rehearsed.

Done on 18 September.
Three exercises.

02

Collapse

Force the field into one state. Contradictions are resolved out loud, words are refused out loud, and what is left is the brand.

This document is the Collapse.

03

Build

Identity, name, voice, object, site, packaging, service design. Nothing is built before the platform is signed.

Next.

04

Hold

The brand is kept honest against the platform, quarter after quarter, as the house grows and the temptation to widen appears.

From launch onward.

Why the exercises were shaped the way they were

Three exercises ran on 18 September, and their design was deliberate. The first was open, and gave the feeling of control. The second was playful. The third dictated the terms completely. That escalation is the method: it moves the founders from stating opinions to defending them.

The first exercise was more free. You had the feeling that you were in control. That wasn't the case, but I gave you the feeling that you were in control.

NIZZAR BEN CHEKROUNE • 00:06:32

The value of the session was not in the words that were picked. It was in the three moments where a word was refused and the refusal had a reason behind it. Those three refusals are on page 10, and two of them became values.

Where divergence pays

Two founders answering identically produce no information. The useful signal sits where they part.

Françoise chose the Explorer. Anna chose the Creator. Neither disagreed with the other. That is the most productive result the exercise can give, and page 08 spends a full page on it.

A note on the room

Three people made coffee at the start of a business meeting and said so. That is not small talk, it is the culture answering the question before the exercise asked it.

One session. *Three exercises. Ninety-six minutes.*

This is the whole evidence base. It is small on purpose. A platform built from one well-run session with the two people who will live inside the brand beats a platform built from a survey of a hundred people who will not.

Who was in the room

PERSON	ROLE, AS IT SHOWED UP IN THE SESSION
Françoise Rapp	The nose. Natural materials, direct relationships with producers, botany. Reads composition as exploration. Supplied every concrete fact about how the product is actually made.
Anna Esen	The expansion. Business architecture, the client relationship, the energetic frame. Supplied the ambition and every refusal that mattered. Nizzar's note at minute fifty-eight: <i>you are all about expansion.</i>
Nizzar Ben Chekroune	Quantum Branding. Ran The Collapse. Arbitrated three vocabulary disputes and made one structural ruling, on page 23.

What the three exercises produced

EXERCISE	OUTPUT	PAGES
01 • Brand DNA a board of twelve archetypes	Three brands each, chosen on values rather than taste. Two picks converged, one diverged.	06 • 07 • 08
02 • The culture five years forward	Five adjectives describing how the team would speak about the house. Four more were argued and refused.	09 • 10
03 • The one client the last commission	Four adjectives agreed. The fifth was under discussion when the available record ends.	11

The business, as described

- A fragrance composed for one named person, from that person.
- Natural materials, ordered from producers Françoise knows, including materials she has never worked with before.
- A second line for establishments. Hotels were named.
- A private club for clients. The fragrance is how you get in.
- Founding ambition: a small boutique maison, elitist. The five-year frame accepted that the house outgrew it.

What is missing, and why it matters

Three further parts of the brand anatomy were scheduled and not reached: tone of voice, look and feel, and value. Section III proposes all three.

A proposal is not a finding. Each is marked, and page 44 asks you to settle them.

Recording: 18 September 2026 • 96 min • Fathom. Available transcript ends at 01:06:49.

Twelve brands on the table. *Pick on values, not on taste.*

The rule was stated before the board was shown, and it is the reason the exercise works. You were not asked which brands you like. You were asked which brands stand where you stand. Disney tested that rule immediately, and passed it.

HERO Nike "Just do it." Courage, perseverance, obstacles overcome. Anna • shortlist	REBEL Harley-Davidson "Live to ride, ride to live." The status quo, challenged.	MAGICIAN Disney "Where dreams come true." Transformation, wonder, escape. Françoise • Anna	EXPLORER Patagonia "We are in business to save our home planet." Discovery, authenticity. Françoise
SAGE TEDx "Ideas worth spreading." Wisdom, truth, the trusted mentor.	INNOCENT Dove "Real beauty." Simplicity, optimism, purity.	EVERYMAN IKEA "Create a better everyday life." Belonging, accessibility.	JESTER Old Spice "The man your man could smell like." Humour, irreverence.
LOVER Gucci "Quality is remembered long after price is forgotten." Desire, intimacy. Françoise • Anna	CAREGIVER not recorded "Stand for tomorrow." Nurture, protection, service. Brand name lost in the recording.	CREATOR Lego "Play unleashed." Invention, imagination, self-expression. Anna	RULER Microsoft Control, leadership, stability, order, legacy. Anna • rejected

The rule that made the exercise work

I do not wait for you to tell me the brands that you like. This is not the exercise. You may not like Disney, but you may very much align with it. It is not a matter of taste. It is a matter of alignment.

NIZZAR BEN CHEKROUNE • 00:09:04

Françoise answered the rule directly: *I see why you told me I dislike the brand, but I like the tagline.* She then chose it. That is the exercise working.

One line worth keeping

Microsoft's stated purpose, read out from the board, is to empower every person and organisation on the planet.

Twenty-seven minutes later Anna refused the word *empowering* for this house, with an argument strong enough to become a value. The board contained the objection before anyone raised it.

See page 10.

Two agreements, *one split*.

Both founders chose the Magician and the Lover, independently, and for different reasons. Two people arriving at the same archetype by different roads is a stronger result than two people agreeing, because neither borrowed the answer.

Agreement 01

The Magician

Françoise. Transformation as the literal mechanism of the product. *Believing in this power of transformation, that you can become. That translates what the power of perfume can be and what we can do with it.* 00:15:11

Anna. Not transformation but revelation. *See the magic. See that what is impossible to be created, possible. See behind the veil. We stopped so much to see the magic.* 00:21:08

What the two readings share. Something present but unseen is made perceptible. That is what a composed scent does physically, and it is the only claim this house can make that is both mystical and true.

Agreement 02

The Lover

Françoise. Took the tagline and claimed it. *Quality is remembered long after the price is forgotten. It could have been our tagline.* 00:15:53

Anna. Turned the Lover inward, which is the more useful reading. *You say to yourself, I love myself enough to create something that expresses my essence. To buy it for yourself, you need to love yourself a lot. It is self-love confirmation.* 00:21:08

What the two readings share. The object is not bought to be seen by others. It is bought as a private act. That single sentence rules out most of the advertising this category runs.

The split

Françoise took Patagonia. Anna took Lego. Neither objected to the other's choice, and Patagonia had been on Anna's own shortlist. The split is not a conflict. It is two halves of the same engine, and page 08 shows why the house needs both.

Anna also weighed Nike and Microsoft. Nike she set aside as an effect of the product rather than a value of the house. Microsoft she refused on the word control, while keeping the idea of legacy.

What the archetype pair already forbids

- NO** Comparative advertising. The Lover does not argue, and the Magician does not explain.
- NO** Discounting. Gucci's line is a direct instruction about price behaviour: quality outlives the number, but only if the number never wavers.
- NO** Demystifying the composition in public. The Magician protects the method. The formula belongs to the client, not to the feed.
- NO** Mass personalisation dressed as bespoke. Both archetypes die the moment the thing is repeatable.

What the pair sounds like in three places

An archetype that never reaches a surface is a diagram. These three are the surfaces where the house will be judged first.

SURFACE	MAGICIAN, REVEALING	LOVER, TURNED INWARD
The first screen of the site	No product. No bottle. A sentence about the person who is reading it.	Addressed to one reader, in the singular, as though the page had been left out for them.
The opening of the consultation	The nose asks about a place, a year, a person. Never about notes the client likes.	Nothing is proposed in the first hour. The client is listened to for longer than is comfortable.
The line on the box	The client's name and the date of the composition. Nothing that describes the contents.	Set small, and placed where only the person holding the box will read it.

THIS PAGE SETTLES the primary archetype pair: Magician and Lover, in that order.

The Explorer and the Creator *are not competing.*

They sit at opposite ends of the same line. One describes how the material arrives. The other describes what the client does once it has. The house needs both, and it needs them in that order.

Françoise • the Explorer, upstream

Her first answer was about nature and materials. Pushed, she gave a second answer that was not in anyone's spectrum, and it changed the positioning.

We work mostly with natural ingredients, producers, and we work with nature. Connected to the nature of botanics, but also the nature of human being. Climate change can affect my work. It is interconnected.

FRANÇOISE RAPP • 00:17:27

As a perfumer, I feel like an explorer, because creating is an exploration. When I make your perfume, it is who you are, what I am going to use. I am going to order ingredients that I don't know, that I haven't worked with.

FRANÇOISE RAPP • 00:19:19

What this is worth. The house buys unfamiliar materials on behalf of a single client. That is expensive, it is inefficient, and it is the proof that the commission is real. Most houses reach for a palette they already own. This one does not, and that fact is the strongest concrete differentiator the session produced.

Anna • the Creator, downstream

Her Lego reading was never about the bottle. It was about what happens to people after the bottle, in the room the house opens for them.

The club, where the people connect. After you have your fragrance. Where you can play, where you can express, where you can connect with others. Come with your most exciting part of you, this childish version of willing to create and self-express.

ANNA ESEN • 00:27:23

What this is worth. It answers the question every house at this price eventually faces: what does the client buy the second time? Here the answer is not a second bottle. It is access that the first bottle already granted.

The ruling that ordered them

You can have different expressions, but you have only one soul. The fragrance is the entry to the club. The club is not the subject, it is the impact.

Nizzar Ben Chekroune • 00:28:14 • agreed by both founders

The spine

Read left to right. The Explorer earns the material. The Magician and the Lover do the reading and the composition. The Creator is what the client becomes once the work is done.

- 01 **Explorer.** Sourcing. Producers, unfamiliar materials, seasons, origin. Françoise's territory, and the house's cost base.
- 02 **Lover.** The reading. One person, studied closely enough that the formula could not fit anyone else.
- 03 **Magician.** The composition. Something already present is made perceptible. This is the step the house never explains in public.
- 04 **Creator.** The aftermath. The client wears it, and enters a room of people who did the same. Anna's territory, and the house's compounding asset.

THIS PAGE SETTLES that Explorer and Creator are both retained, as a sequence, not as a choice.

Five words the team would use, *five years from now.*

The frame: the house has outgrown the boutique maison it was meant to be, the founders have chartered a plane, and the whole team is in the air on the way to an island they have not been told about. The question is not what you would say about the house. It is what they would.

01	02	03	04	05
Supportive	Visionary	Unique	Efficient	Entrepreneurial
WORD	WHAT IT MEANT IN THE ROOM		THE BEHAVIOUR IT COMMITS THE HOUSE TO	
Supportive	Arrived after <i>empowering</i> was refused. Françoise: <i>we are creating a supportive environment for our team to grow, to expand, like our clients.</i> She gave a concrete example: a single mother on the team who does not have to worry about her children.		Support is structural, not emotional. It is childcare, hours, and money, decided before anyone has to ask for them. A house that says supportive and makes people ask has said nothing.	
Visionary	The only word agreed with no argument at all. Anna: <i>definitely agreed upon with two hands.</i>		The house states where the category is going and then goes there first, in public, under its own name. Vision that is only spoken internally is planning.	
Unique	Anna moved it from the product to the people: <i>the uniqueness of every individual being a part of the company, and bringing their uniqueness on the table.</i> Respectful was then dropped as already contained here.		No two roles in this house are written from the same template. Hiring reads for what a person brings that nobody else does, and the job is shaped around it afterwards.	
Efficient	Anna proposed it against her own taste: <i>it is not the sexiest word.</i> Nizzar kept it precisely for that: <i>we need something that is grounding.</i>		Efficiency is spent on time, not on output. Ten hours of work that used to take forty converts into time returned to the person, at the same pay. This is the value that costs money.	
Entrepreneurial	A translation problem that turned into the best definition of the day. Françoise meant <i>entreprendre</i> . Anna offered her own word for it: <i>workpreneur</i> . Nizzar named the three parts: trust, attunement to one's own creative power, and action taken without returning for permission.		People are hired for judgement and then allowed to use it. The founders expect to be told what to do by the people they hired, and to be grown by them.	

It doesn't make sense to hire smart people and then tell them what to do. We hire smart people so they tell us what to do.

STEVE JOBS, QUOTED IN THE SESSION • 00:55:51 • BOTH FOUNDERS AGREED

Why efficiency is the load-bearing one

Supportive, visionary and unique are easy to claim. Efficient is the only one of the five that can be checked from outside, in hours and in headcount. It is also the one that pays for the other four.

THIS PAGE SETTLES the five culture values. They appear again as behaviour on pages 18 and 19.

Four words were argued *and thrown out*.

This is the most useful page in Section I. A word that survives an argument is worth five words that were never tested. Two of these refusals became rules the house now runs on.

Refused 01 • became a rule

Empowering

Françoise offered it first. Anna refused it, and the refusal is the sharpest thing said all session.

A woman doesn't need to be empowered. We have been sold the story of empowering as if we don't carry the power within ourselves. You see a mother whose baby is threatened. She will kill you. You don't need to empower her.

ANNA ESEN • 00:40:10

Françoise did not defend the word. She found the thing underneath it, and the room agreed on **supportive** in one move.

The rule it produced. This house never addresses a person as incomplete. Not a client, not a candidate, not a member of the team. Every sentence assumes the power is already there and offers a better instrument for it. The word is banned from all copy, internal and external. Page 26 carries it into the lexicon.

Refused 02 • absorbed

Respectful

Françoise proposed it. Anna paused on it, and Nizzar named the problem: *it is already implied. If you are supportive, you respect people. It is a waste of an adjective.* 00:47:08

Refused 03 • absorbed

Cutting edge

Anna proposed it, for a real reason: *we are completely destroying the way companies create fragrances.* Françoise took it apart. A house that knows where it is going and does it in a way nobody else does is already at the edge. Saying so adds nothing and spends a slot. Anna agreed immediately.

Verbatim from the exercise material. The house does not use this phrase in its own copy.

Refused 04 • relocated

Present

Anna proposed it and meant something precise: attention as the condition for the work to carry anything. Françoise objected on the grounds of the exercise, not the idea. *I don't know if people would talk about the company like that. That is a state of being.* 00:52:08

Where it went. Not lost. Presence is not how a team describes an employer, it is how a house runs a consultation. It reappears twice: as *conscious* in the client profile on page 11, and as a service rule on page 40.

The discipline underneath all four

Five slots. A word that is contained by another word spends a slot and buys nothing. That test removed two candidates in under a minute and it is worth keeping permanently, because it applies to far more than adjectives. It applies to product lines, to service tiers, to channels, and to the objects named on page 39.

Keep the phrase. *A waste of an adjective* is now house shorthand for anything that duplicates something the house already has.

The pattern in the refusals

Three of the four were refused for the same underlying reason: the word had become common currency and had stopped carrying weight.

That instinct is itself a brand asset, and Section III turns it into a working lexicon rather than leaving it as a shared allergy.

One commission left. *Who gets it?*

The frame was absolute. The house is rich, everything works, and the universe permits exactly one more client. Not a segment. One person, with a name and a face. Four adjectives were agreed. The fifth is still open.

01 • Anna

Influential

People already standing where they can move the world. Françoise added the second reading: their circle is how the house grows, because they refer.

02 • Françoise

Passionate

A drive, not a hobby. They love scent, and they are consumed by something else too: art, work, a cause. Both founders saw the word at the same moment.

03 • Anna

Conscious

The counterweight. Anna: *influential and passionate can turn into disruptive power*. Three alternatives were tested and dropped.

04 • Françoise

Wealthy

Said plainly and without apology: *because we want people to have the money to buy our products*. Anna agreed without qualification.

Why conscious, and not the three words near it

TESTED

WHY IT FELL

Enlightened

Anna: *these are the people who believe they don't need food, they don't need perfumes, they are already gods in the flesh*. A person with nothing left to want is not a client.

Spiritual

Carries too much freight, and narrows the house to one vocabulary.

Intelligent

Nizzar would have kept it. Anna closed it: *Bill Gates is intelligent, but with the influence and the passion, he can destroy*. Intelligence is not a direction.

Change agents

Anna wanted it. Françoise refused it as too narrow for a whole clientele. The niche logic behind Anna's argument was affirmed separately and survives on page 22.

It is easier to walk down from the peak of the mountain than to climb it. We start with these people, because they make the others follow.

NIZZAR BEN CHEKROUNE • 01:04:28

The calibration, and the gap

Nizzar tested the first three against real people. Influential, passionate and conscious could describe Michael Jackson. They could equally describe Mother Teresa, or the Dalai Lama. Wealthy removes two of the three. The fifth adjective is what separates the client this house wants from the merely rich.

The available recording ends during that discussion. The fifth word was never landed.

PROPOSAL

A candidate for the fifth: self-possessed

It is the client-side of the word the culture exercise refused. Anna threw out *empowering* because the house must never address someone as if the power were missing. The client profile should say the same thing from the other side: this house is for people who arrived whole and want an instrument, not a rescue.

It also earns its slot, which the test on page 10 demands. It rules out the wealthy buyer who purchases to be seen, and it makes the discretion rules on page 21 load-bearing rather than decorative.

Alternates, if you want the fifth to do different work: **private**, which protects the same client from the house itself, or **exacting**, which justifies the number of trials and the price.

OPEN the fifth adjective. Decision 01 on page 44.

Everything the session produced, *on one page.*

Read down the three columns. The platform in Section II is built from nothing that is not here, and every derived claim is traceable to one of these cells.

Exercise 01 • what the house
is

Archetype

Magician. Something present but unseen is made perceptible.

Lover. A private act, not a display. Quality outlives price.

Explorer upstream, at the materials.

Creator downstream, in the client.

Refused: Ruler, on the word control. Hero, as an effect rather than a value.

Exercise 02 • how the house
runs

Culture

Supportive. Structural, decided before it is asked for.

Visionary. Stated in public, first.

Unique. Applied to people, not to product.

Efficient. Spent on time, not on output.

Entrepreneurial. Trust, judgement, action without permission.

Refused: empowering, respectful, cutting edge, present.

Exercise 03 • who the house
is for

The client

Influential. Already standing where they move things.

Passionate. A drive, not a taste.

Conscious. Aware of what their influence does.

Wealthy. Stated without apology.

OPEN The fifth. Proposed: self-possessed.

Refused: enlightened, spiritual, intelligent, change agents.

The Collapse

Three exercises, run separately, produced the same instruction. *Do not add anything to the person.* The Magician reveals rather than transforms. The Lover is turned inward, toward the self, not outward toward an audience. The culture refused the one word in the board that promised to add power. And the client is chosen for already having it.

That is a single, unusually consistent position, and it is rare for a category built almost entirely on the opposite promise. Every mainstream fragrance brand sells becoming. This house sells recognition. Section II is the working out of that one sentence.

What was extracted that nobody expected

Françoise buying unfamiliar materials for one client, and Anna's reading of the purchase as an act of self-love rather than of taste. Neither was on the board. Both came out under pressure, and both are now load-bearing.

What is still missing

The fifth client adjective. Voice, look and feel as exercises. The name. Four open items, all listed on page 44.

You already are someone.

That is the whole premise. Nothing in this house is built to complete you, correct you or lift you. The power arrived long before we did.

What is missing is not the power. It is the proof.

So we read. One person, closely, for as long as it takes. Then we go and find the materials, including the ones we have never worked with, and we compose the thing that could not fit anybody else.

It is made once. The formula is yours. We do not make it again, for anyone, ever.

Some of it will look like magic. It is attention.

Reason for being, mission, *vision*.

Three statements that do three different jobs. The first explains why the house should exist at all. The second is what it does on a Tuesday. The third is the state of the world it is working toward, and it has to be large enough to survive being reached.

Reason for being

Because a person is already someone, and almost nothing in the world says so back.

The category sells becoming. Wear this and you will be desired, powerful, free. The premise is that you are not yet. This house was founded by two people who do not believe that, and one of them refused the word for it out loud.

Mission

To read one person closely enough that the formula could not fit anyone else, and to go and find whatever it takes to build it.

Two verbs, and they belong to the two founders. Reading is the consultation. Finding is the sourcing, including materials the nose has never used, ordered for one commission.

Vision

A house whose clients recognise each other before they are introduced.

It is the club, stated as an outcome instead of as a feature. It also contains the commercial ambition honestly: recognition at that level is what makes referral the only channel the house needs.

Anna's five-year frame, and Françoise's circle of influence, arriving at the same place.

How to use these three

They are not copy. None of the three sentences above should appear on a website as written. They are the test a piece of work has to pass before it ships.

WHEN YOU ARE DECIDING	ASK
Whether to take a commission	Can we read this person? If the client wants a scent they already imagined, the house is being used as a supplier. Refuse or reframe.
Whether to add a product	Does it come out of reading one person? A candle does not. An establishment accord does, because a hotel is a subject that can be read.
Whether a sentence is on-brand	Does it tell the reader they are lacking something? If yes, it is off-brand regardless of how well it is written.
Whether to hire someone	Will we be told what to do by this person within a year? If not, the house has hired a pair of hands.

THIS PAGE SETTLES reason for being, mission and vision.

The sentence that does the most work

What is missing is not the power. It is the proof.

It holds the Magician and the Lover at once, it survives translation into French, and it is the shortest expression of the position the three exercises converged on.

It is a candidate for the public line. It is not yet the tagline, because the name is not settled and the two are chosen together. Page 39.

Six beliefs, *and what each one costs.*

A belief that costs nothing is a slogan. Each of these removes an option the house could otherwise have taken, and the removed option is printed next to it. If a cost looks unacceptable, the belief is the thing to argue with, not the cost.

WE BELIEVE	BECAUSE	WHAT IT COSTS US
Power is not given.	Nobody walks in here incomplete. This came out of the room as a refusal, not as a position, which is why it is first.	The entire persuasion engine of the category. The house cannot sell aspiration, and aspiration is what sells fragrance.
Quality outlives the price, but only if the price never moves.	Both founders claimed Gucci's line. Read as an instruction rather than a compliment, it is about pricing behaviour.	Sales, gifting promotions, outlet, seasonal offers, friends-of-the-house rates. One discount and the line becomes decoration.
A material has an origin, a season and a person behind it.	Françoise buys from producers she knows. That is a supply chain and it is also the only verifiable claim in a category full of unverifiable ones.	Margin. Naming the origin means buying at the harvest from a producer who can be named, not at the best quote from a broker.
Magic is accuracy.	The Magician was chosen twice, and both readings described perception, not conjuring. What reads as magic is someone having paid an unusual amount of attention.	Time, which is the house's scarcest input. The reading cannot be scripted and cannot be delegated without becoming something else.
Repetition ends the promise.	A formula made twice was never a portrait. It was a product with a story attached.	The single most profitable thing a perfume house can sell, which is a second bottle of something that already worked.
Natural is a constraint, not a virtue.	Naturals carry origin, season and a producer. They also vary between batches, they fade faster than synthetics, and several are potent allergens. The house works with them for the first reason and manages the rest.	The easiest marketing story in the category. The house does not claim that natural is safer, cleaner or kinder, because a perfumer knows better and a client will eventually find out.

How a belief gets tested

Beliefs are tested by the offers the house turns down. Three that will arrive within the first two years, and the answer to each is already written above.

- **A department store wants an exclusive.** Refused. Not on snobbery, on belief two: the house cannot control price behaviour once the bottle sits on someone else's shelf.
- **A client asks for six bottles for six friends.** Refused as written, offered as six commissions. Belief five.
- **A distributor wants a clean beauty certification story.** Refused. Belief six. The house will publish its material list and let people draw conclusions.

The one to watch

Belief two will be under pressure before any of the others, and it will be under pressure from inside. A slow quarter makes a discount look like a tactic rather than a breach.

Write the refusal down now, while nothing is at stake. That is the point of a platform.

Essence, promise, *positioning*.

Three tools of decreasing abstraction. The essence is one word you never say out loud. The promise is the sentence the house is held to. The positioning is the paragraph a new employee, a journalist or a lawyer can be handed.

Essence • internal only

Portrait.

A portrait is made from a sitter, by an artist, once. It is not a likeness the sitter chose, it is what the artist saw. Nobody commissions a portrait to become someone else.

Every structural decision here falls out of that word: the sitting, the single copy, the signature, the refusal to repeat.

Promise • said out loud

One person. One reading. One formula, made once.

Short enough to survive a phone call, specific enough to be broken. If there is no way to fail a promise, it is a mood.

How it fails. A second bottle of the same formula. A reading conducted by someone other than the nose. A commission accepted from a client the house never met.

Reason to believe

The three proofs

- 01 **The material list ships with the bottle.** Origin and season named. Page 35.
- 02 **The formula is retired on delivery** and the retirement is recorded with a number and a date the client can quote.
- 03 **Materials are bought for the commission,** including ones the nose has not worked with. The invoice exists. It is the proof nobody else in the category can produce cheaply.

The positioning paragraph

For influential, passionate and conscious people with the means to be met precisely, **[the house]** is a natural perfume maison that reads one person and composes a formula belonging to them alone. Unlike luxury fragrance, which sells the promise of becoming someone else, this house makes perceptible what is already there, from materials with a named origin, and never makes that formula again.

The bracket holds until Section IV closes. Everything else in the paragraph is settled.

FOR WHOM	Four of the five adjectives from Exercise 03.
WHAT IT IS	A maison, not a brand or a studio. A maison has a nose in it.
AGAINST WHAT	Luxury fragrance as a whole, named. Not other bespoke perfumers, who are too few and too aligned to be the enemy.
WHY BELIEVE IT	Named origin, retired formula. Both checkable by the client.

What it deliberately omits

Price. Location. The founders' names. The club. Each is true, and each would tie the paragraph to a moment. A positioning statement that needs rewriting when the house moves premises was written badly.

THIS PAGE SETTLES essence, promise and positioning. The name inside the paragraph stays open until page 39.

Four archetypes, *weighted*.

An unweighted blend is four brands in a trench coat. These proportions decide which archetype wins when two of them want different things, and that happens more often than anyone expects.

40 per cent • lead Magician Reveals. Does not explain. Owns the composition and protects the method. Speaks in the work, not about it.	35 per cent • lead Lover Turned inward. A private act between the house and one person. Owns price behaviour, discretion and the object.	15 per cent • support Explorer Upstream only. Materials, producers, seasons, the unfamiliar order. Never the customer-facing posture.	10 per cent • support Creator Downstream only. What the client does afterwards, in the club. Never applied to the product.
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Who wins the arguments that are coming

THE ARGUMENT	THE RULING, AND WHICH ARCHETYPE MAKES IT
Should the site explain how a formula is built?	No. Magician over Explorer. The sourcing story is told through named materials on the card that ships with the bottle, where it is proof rather than content.
Should the club be visible from outside?	Barely. Lover over Creator. Its existence is known, its inside is not. A club you can see into is a mailing list.
Should the house publish the nose's sourcing travel?	Only after the fact, and only as material provenance. Magician again. Travel content turns the house into a documentary about itself.
Should a client be able to request a material?	Yes, and it is recorded. Lover over Magician. Refusing a client's own memory of a place would be mysticism at the client's expense.

The four the house must not drift into

- **Sage.** The drift is teaching. A natural perfumer has a great deal to teach, and every hour spent teaching converts the maison into a school. Signal: the blog outgrows the client list.
- **Innocent.** The drift arrives through the word natural, as purity. Belief six forbids it. Signal: the words free from appear anywhere.
- **Ruler.** Anna refused it on the word control. The drift is the house correcting a client's taste. Signal: a client is told what suits them.
- **Everyman.** The drift is accessibility, usually arriving as a smaller bottle at a lower price. It ends the Lover. Signal: the phrase entry point is used internally.

THIS PAGE SETTLES the weighting, and which archetype has the casting vote.

The five values, *written as behaviour*.

A value stated as an adjective cannot be broken, which makes it useless. Each of the five is rewritten below as something the house does, something it refuses, and the signal that says it has stopped being true.

Value 01

Supportive

What it means here. Support is a structure, decided and funded before anyone has to ask. Françoise named the example herself: a person on the team who does not have to worry about her children. Support that has to be requested has already failed, because the request costs the person something.

We do

- YES** Publish the terms. Hours, leave, care arrangements, and what happens in a bad month, written down before the first hire.
- YES** Pay for the thing rather than reimburse it.

We refuse

- NO** Benefits that require a conversation with a founder.
- NO** Flexibility offered as a favour, which is flexibility that can be withdrawn.

Failure signal

Someone thanks a founder personally for something that should have been a policy. That is the sound of support running on goodwill.

Value 02

Visionary

What it means here. The only value agreed with no argument, which makes it the easiest to let go soft. Vision is a position stated in public, under the house's name, before it is safe. Vision kept internal is planning, and planning is not a value.

We do

- YES** Say plainly what the house thinks the category gets wrong, and sign it.
- YES** Commit to the position in the product first, then in words.

We refuse

- NO** Trend commentary. A house that reacts is not seeing anything.
- NO** Predictions with no consequence attached to being wrong.

Failure signal

The house is quoted in a trend piece about a movement it did not start. Being included is pleasant and it is evidence of following.

Value 03

Unique

What it means here. Anna moved this word off the product and onto people, and that move is the whole value. The product being one of one is a fact. The house treating every person in it as one of one is a choice, and it is made in the hiring, not in the language.

We do

- YES** Write the role after meeting the person, around what they carry that nobody else does.
- YES** Keep the headcount low enough that this stays possible.

We refuse

- NO** Job templates. Interchangeable titles.
- NO** Hiring for a gap on an organisation chart.

Failure signal

Two people in the house could swap jobs on a Monday and nobody would notice by Friday.

The two that cost money, *and the two tests.*

Value 04

Efficient

What it means here. Anna proposed it against her own taste and Nizzar kept it for being grounding. It is the only value of the five that can be audited from outside. The rule is that the gains are spent on time, not on output. Work that used to take forty hours and now takes ten returns thirty hours to the person, at unchanged pay. A house that banks the thirty hours has an efficiency programme, not a value.

We do

- YES** Measure hours worked, and treat a rise as a failure of design rather than a sign of commitment.
- YES** Automate the administration, never the reading.

We refuse

- NO** Growth that is paid for in hours.
- NO** Presence as a proxy for contribution.

Failure signal

Revenue per person rises while hours per person also rise. That combination means the house is selling its team's time and calling it efficiency.

Value 05

Entrepreneurial

What it means here. Read it in French. *Entreprendre*, to take something on. Anna's own coinage for it was *workpreneur*. The session broke it into three parts and all three have to be present: the house trusts the person, the person is attuned to their own judgement, and the person acts without returning for permission.

We do

- YES** Give a decision away with its budget attached.
- YES** Expect to be told what to do by the person hired to do it, within the first year.

We refuse

- NO** Approval chains for reversible decisions.
- NO** Punishing a reversible mistake made in good judgement.

Failure signal

A founder is the last approval on something neither founder understands better than the person asking.

The hiring test

One question, asked of every candidate, and it comes straight out of the session.

Tell me about a time you did the right thing without asking, and what it cost you.

An answer with no cost in it is a story about being praised. The house is looking for the person who paid something and would do it again. That is *entreprendre*, and it cannot be taught after the fact.

The annual test

Once a year, put the five values in front of the whole team and ask two questions. Do not ask whether the values are true.

- 01 Which of the five did we break this year, and on what date?
- 02 Which one has quietly stopped costing us anything?

The second question is the dangerous one. A value that costs nothing has been downgraded to a description, and page 15 explains why that is the end of it.

THIS PAGE SETTLES the five values as behaviour, with a failure signal each.

What this house *is not*.

Five adjacent categories the house will be mistaken for, by journalists, by investors and by its own team on a tired afternoon. Each one is a plausible business. None of them is this one, and the page says what the drift into each actually looks like.

NOT THIS	WHY IT IS TEMPTING	WHAT THE DRIFT LOOKS LIKE FROM INSIDE
Not a fragrance brand	It is the only model anyone in the category knows how to finance, and it scales.	A launch calendar appears. Then a limited edition. Then a summer version. None of them came from reading a person, and the promise on page 16 is already dead.
Not a wellness brand	Anna's vocabulary reaches for energy and consciousness, and a large market is waiting there with money in hand.	Copy starts implying effect. Calm, balance, sleep, healing. Those are regulated claims in most of the markets this house sells into, and they are also untrue.
Not a personalisation service	It is the cheap version of the same sentence, and the technology to fake it is sitting there.	A questionnaire appears on the site. A quiz. A configurator with eight bases and twelve modifiers. Page 07 already named this: mass personalisation dressed as bespoke.
Not a lifestyle house	Candles, soap and linen spray carry a good margin and the client asks for them.	The extension is defensible one product at a time and indefensible in aggregate. A candle cannot be read from a person, so it belongs to a different house.
Not a clean beauty brand	Natural materials make the story free, and retailers ask for it.	The phrase <i>free from</i> appears. Certification follows. Belief six is gone, and a perfumer has publicly claimed something she knows to be untrue.

The one that will actually happen

Not the wellness drift, which both founders would catch. The lifestyle drift, because it arrives as a favour. A client who loves her formula asks for a candle of it for her house. Saying no feels ungenerous, the margin is good, and it is one candle.

The answer, decided now, in writing. The house does not put a personal formula into any object other than the bottle it was composed for. If a client wants her house to smell of something, that is a second commission, read from the house rather than from her, and it is a different formula with its own number. The principle is on page 23.

A test for any new idea

Three questions. All three have to pass.

- 01 Was it read from one subject?
- 02 Is it made once?
- 03 Would the nose sign it?

Two out of three is a no. Most of the ideas on this page score two.

Always. *Never.*

The platform reduced to instructions a new person can follow on their first week without understanding any of it. Everything here is derived from a page earlier in this section, and the reference is printed so the reasoning can be found.

Always

YES	Name the material, its origin and its season on the card that ships with the bottle.	p15
YES	Have the nose conduct the reading in person. If that is impossible, postpone it.	p16
YES	Record the formula number and the date it was retired, and give both to the client.	p23
YES	Declare the allergen content plainly. Naturals carry them, and a client will find out.	p15
YES	Answer a client inside one working day, including when the answer is not ready yet.	p40
YES	Return the sourcing cost if a commission is abandoned after materials were bought.	p40
YES	Write down every refusal and its date. The refusals are the brand.	p20
YES	Publish the capacity honestly, and only if the number is true.	p41

Never

NO	Compose a personal formula for a second person. No exception exists.	p23
NO	Tell a person what suits them. Ask, compose, present.	p17
NO	Publish a client's name without a signed release, and never as a testimonial.	p22
NO	Discount, gift a discount, or set the price by market.	p15
NO	Claim an effect. Calming, healing, balancing, seductive.	p20
NO	Use the word empowering, on any surface, internal or external.	p10
NO	Sell through anyone who can set the price.	p15
NO	Photograph a client's bottle for the house's own use.	p33

Two of these will be tested in year one

The discount. It will arrive as a favour to a first client who introduced three others. The generous move is to refuse the discount and give something that is not money: an earlier slot, a larger presentation, the nose's time. Money given back says the price was never real.

The testimonial. An influential client will offer, unprompted, to say something publicly. It will be difficult to decline and it should still be declined in that form. The Lover does not perform. What the house can accept instead is on page 22, under the fourth door.

Where these live

Not in this document. On one page, in the room where the work happens, and inside the onboarding of every person who joins.

A rule nobody can recite is a rule that will be broken by someone acting in good faith, which is the most expensive way for it to happen.

Four doors. *Only one of them is marketing.*

People do not arrive at a house like this through a funnel. They arrive through one of four doors, each carrying a different belief about what is behind it, and each needing a different first move. Three of the four are opened by someone who is already a client.

Door 01 • the majority

The referred

Arrives believing that a friend has something they cannot buy.

First move. Not a sale. A question about the person who sent them, which tells the house what they already understand.

Do not send a brochure. They have already had the only brochure that works, which is a person wearing it.

Door 02 • the line that pays the rent

The establishment

Arrives believing they are buying an amenity. Hotels were named in the session.

First move. Reframe the subject. A hotel can be read like a person: its site, its age, its light, what it was before.

Do not quote per litre. The moment the conversation is about volume, the house has become a supplier.

Door 03 • the difficult one

The gift

Arrives believing they can commission a portrait of someone else.

First move. Explain what is actually being bought: the sitting. The recipient still has to be read, and can decline.

Do not accept a commission for an absent subject. It breaks the promise on page 16 at the first step.

Door 04 • the compounding one

The member

Arrives believing nothing in particular. They are brought in by a client, to a room, before they ever consider a commission.

First move. None. This door is not sold through. It is the club doing the work the house is forbidden from doing.

Do not put a commercial moment inside the club. Page 24.

Why the doors are ordered this way

Anna argued for the narrowest possible client and Françoise argued that the narrowest definition would exclude too much of the clientele. Both were right about different things, and the session settled it in one image.

It is easier to walk down from the peak of the mountain than to climb it. We start with these people, because they make the others follow, rather than starting large and trying to go niche afterwards.

NIZZAR BEN CHEKROUNE • 01:04:28

So the house aims every action at door one, at the narrowest and most influential client it can reach, and lets doors two, three and four fill from the pressure that creates. There is no separate acquisition programme, and there does not need to be one for several years.

What the house does instead of a testimonial

A client who wants to say something publicly is offered a different form: they may say that they have a formula, and they may say who made it. They do not describe it, and the house does not repeat what they said.

Existence is public. Contents are not. That distinction protects the client, protects the Lover, and is more persuasive than praise, because it cannot be bought.

THIS PAGE SETTLES the four doors, and that door one takes the house's whole effort.

Made once. *Refilled forever.*

The promise on page 16 says a formula is made once. Read carelessly, that sentence destroys the best revenue a house like this has. Read precisely, it creates it. The distinction is the most commercially important paragraph in this document.

The rule, stated exactly

A formula is **composed once**, from one person, and is never composed for a second person. It is **remade for its owner on request, for as long as the house exists.**

Composing is the singular act. Remaking is service. Confusing the two would mean either selling the same portrait twice, which ends the promise, or refusing a client her own perfume, which is absurd.

Why this is the commercial engine

Natural materials fade. A formula built on naturals will not hold for years in a drawer, and the client who wears it daily will finish a bottle. Both facts point the same way: the client comes back, and the house has already done the expensive part.

The first commission carries the reading, the sourcing and the trials. Every refill after it carries materials and labour only. The relationship is where the margin lives, and it is also where the club recruits.

What this means for pricing. The commission is priced for the reading, not for the liquid. The refill is priced for the liquid. Publishing that logic is persuasive, because it explains a number that would otherwise look arbitrary.

The four requests that will test it

THE REQUEST	ANSWER	WHY, AND WHAT IS OFFERED INSTEAD
My husband loves mine. Make him one of these.	NO	It is a second person wearing a portrait of the first. Offered instead: his own commission, at full price, with the house noting the relationship in the reading if he wants it heard.
Can I have it in a candle for the house?	NO	A room is not the subject the formula was read from. Offered instead: a second commission read from the house itself, with its own number. Page 20.
I have finished the bottle.	YES	This is the refill, and it should be the easiest transaction the house runs. One message, no reconsultation, no upsell.
I have changed. Can it change with me?	YES, AS A NEW WORK	The most interesting request the house will receive. A second reading, a second number, and the first formula stays in the register under its own name rather than being overwritten. A person is allowed more than one portrait in a life.

The register

The rule needs an object, or it is a claim. The house keeps a register: one line per formula, carrying a number, the client's name, the date of the reading, the date of composition, and the date it was closed to the palette. The client receives that line, signed by the nose, with the bottle.

It costs almost nothing, it is impossible to fake retrospectively, and it is the physical form of the entire promise. It is also the single artefact most likely to be photographed by a client, which is the only photograph the house should want.

One thing to decide early

What happens to a formula when its owner dies. The generous answer, and the one that fits this house, is that it passes with the estate and can be refilled by whoever holds it, and is still never composed for anyone else.

Decision 04, page 44.

THIS PAGE SETTLES that composition is singular and refilling is perpetual.

The club. *The impact, never the subject.*

Anna brought it into the session through Lego, as a room where clients play, create and meet. Nizzar made the only structural ruling of the day about it, both founders agreed on the spot, and this page is that ruling turned into a working design.

The fragrance is the entry to the club, but the club is not the subject. It is the impact.

NIZZAR BEN CHEKROUNE, AGREED BY ANNA ESEN • 00:28:14

What that ruling actually forbids

It forbids the club from ever appearing in the sale. Not from existing, not from being known, not from being wonderful. From being *offered*. The moment a prospect is told that buying a formula grants access to a room of influential people, the house has sold a membership with a perfume attached, and the portrait has become a coupon.

This matters more than it sounds, because the club is genuinely the most valuable thing on offer to an influential client, and every commercial instinct will point at putting it in the deck.

ALLOWED

FORBIDDEN

A client learns the club exists after the commission is agreed.

The club named on the site, in a proposal, or in a price list.

A member brings a guest. Door 04.

A membership sold, or a tier that includes access.

The house hosts, pays and disappears.

A commercial moment inside the room. No presentations, no launches, no orders taken.

Members find each other and do their own business.

The house brokering that business or taking a position in it.

What the room is for

Anna described it precisely: a place to arrive with the part of yourself that wants to make something. Not networking. The distinction is that nobody enters the room needing anything from anyone else in it, which is what makes the room rare and what makes it work.

Everyone there has been read closely by the same person. That is a genuinely unusual thing to have in common, and it is the only membership criterion.

The cheapest version that is still true

Do not build a club. Build a dinner. Eight people, once, hosted by the founders, no programme and no speeches.

If the second dinner is requested by the guests rather than proposed by the house, the club exists. If it is not, the house has learned that cheaply.

THIS PAGE SETTLES that the club is never sold, named in a proposal, or monetised.

Four anchors. *Everything else is style.*

PROPOSAL

Tone of voice was scheduled as an exercise and the session did not reach it. What follows is built from how the two of you actually spoke for ninety-six minutes, which is a better source than a word list would have been. React to it. It is not settled until you say so.

Anchor 01

Assume the power.

Never address anyone as if something were missing from them. Not a client, not a candidate, not a supplier. This is Anna's refusal turned into a writing rule, and it is the one anchor that can be checked mechanically: if a sentence implies a lack, rewrite it.

Sounds like. *You know what you want to be near.*

Not. *Discover the scent that reveals your true self.*

Anchor 02

Name the material, not the mood.

Françoise talks in origins, seasons and producers. That is the house's register and it is also its proof. Mood words are available to every brand in the category at no cost, which is exactly what they are worth.

Sounds like. *Vetiver from Haiti, distilled in September. Orris that sat for four years before it was worth anything.*

Not. *Warm, woody, mysterious.*

Anchor 03

Say less than you know.

The Magician holds 40 per cent of the blend and its instruction is to reveal through the work rather than to explain around it. Withholding is the register of this house. It is also commercially correct: the method is the only asset that cannot be copied once it is published.

Sounds like. *There are nineteen materials in it. Eleven of them you would not recognise.*

Not. *a breakdown of the accord structure.*

Anchor 04

Speak to one person.

Always the singular. No *our clients*, no *people like you*, no segments. The Lover turned inward means every sentence the house writes is written as though it will be read by one person alone, because commercially it nearly is.

Sounds like. *You will sit with Françoise for three hours.*

Not. *Our clients enjoy an intimate consultation.*

How the two founders sound, and why both stay

FRANÇOISE	Concrete, material, slightly hesitant in the best way. She reaches for an example rather than an adjective. She is the voice of everything about the work itself.
ANNA	Structural, fast, unafraid of a large claim, and willing to refuse a word in public. She is the voice of what the house believes and what it will not do.
THE HOUSE	Françoise's concreteness with Anna's spine. Never one without the other. Concreteness alone becomes a supplier. Conviction alone becomes a manifesto with nothing underneath it.

The test, read aloud

Read the sentence as though you were saying it to a client sitting opposite you, who can afford anything and has heard every version of this pitch.

If you would be embarrassed, the sentence is wrong. That test caught every bad line in this document and it will catch every bad line in the site.

Mechanics, *and the words this house will not use.*

Mechanics

- **Short sentences.** Fragments are allowed and encouraged. *Made once. Yours.*
- **Contractions in speech and letters.** Never on the object itself, where the register is formal because the object outlives the conversation.
- **Numerals for facts, words for rhetoric.** *Formula 0041, nineteen materials.* A number that can be checked is written as a number.
- **No exclamation marks.** Anywhere. The house does not raise its voice.
- **French material names stay in French.** The house does not translate *absolue*, *enfleurage* or a producer's own word for a harvest.
- **Second person singular.** in every language that distinguishes it. In French, *vous* until the client says otherwise, then never back.
- **Dates are written in full.** Seasons and years are the house's evidence, so they are never abbreviated.

One structural habit worth keeping

Both founders answer a question by narrowing it before they answer. That habit is the house's natural rhythm and it should survive into the writing: state the distinction, then answer the smaller question.

The lexicon

Left column banned outright. The replacement is sometimes silence, which is a legitimate answer.

NEVER	INSTEAD
empowering, empower	Nothing. Rewrite the sentence so it does not need the idea. Decided in the session.
bespoke	Composed for one person. The category word has been diluted past use.
luxury, luxurious	Silence. A house that says it is luxury is telling you it is not obvious.
olfactory journey, sensorial experience	The sitting. The consultation. The bottle.
notes of	The material, its origin, its year.
signature scent	Your formula. It has a number.
curated	Chosen, and name who chose.
artisanal, handcrafted	Made by Françoise, in the atelier, on a date.
timeless, iconic	Delete. Both are claims about a future nobody can check.
unisex	The house does not gender a formula, and does not describe one as ungendered either.
clean, free from, chemical-free	The material list. Belief six.
elevate, transform, unleash	Delete. Each implies the reader was lower before.
exclusive, limited	The actual number, or nothing.

PROPOSAL voice mechanics and lexicon. Decision 02, page 44.

Three rewrites. *The same information, twice.*

The left column is not a straw man. It is the register this category actually writes in, and it is what a competent agency would deliver on a first pass. The right column is the same content put through the four anchors.

Before • the first screen of a site

Discover your signature scent. Our master perfumer crafts a bespoke olfactory journey that reveals the truest version of you, using the world's finest natural ingredients. Begin your transformation today.

Four anchor breaches. It tells the reader they are not yet themselves, it names no material, it explains the method, and it addresses a crowd.

After

You already know what you want to be near.

Françoise will sit with you for three hours to find out what it is made of.

One reader. No promise of change. The specific number of hours is the proof, and it is the only claim on the screen that could be checked or broken.

Before • replying to a first enquiry

Thank you so much for reaching out! We would love to welcome you into our world. Our bespoke experience starts at 12,000 euros and includes an exclusive consultation, a personalised fragrance profile and a luxurious presentation box. Spaces are limited, so do let us know soon!

Two exclamation marks, manufactured scarcity, and the word the house banned in the session sitting inside a list of features.

After

Thank you for writing.

A commission is 12,000 euros. That pays for a reading with Françoise, the materials, which are bought for you and sometimes for the first time, and between three and six trials until you recognise yourself in it.

She composes eleven a year. The next sitting available is in March.

If you would like it, tell me one place you have been that you have not forgotten.

Scarcity stated as a production fact, which is the only honest form of it. The last line is the reading beginning before the invoice.

Before • a delay

We sincerely apologise for the inconvenience. Due to unforeseen supply chain challenges, your order will be slightly delayed. We appreciate your patience and are committed to delivering an exceptional experience.

After

The iris we are waiting on was harvested late. It will not be ready to work with until the second week of April, and using the previous year's would change the formula. Your bottle will reach you in May rather than March. Nothing else has changed.

No apology, because none is owed for a season. The material is named. The client is told what the alternative would have cost her, which is the whole argument for the delay.

Five principles. *Everything after this is derived.*

PROPOSAL

Look and feel was the other exercise the session did not reach. This direction is derived from the platform rather than from a mood board, which means every choice on pages 29 to 35 can be argued with by pointing at the principle it came from.

01

Ivory, not cream

The surface sets the temperature of the whole house. Cream, oat and sand are the default of every natural and botanical brand on the shelf. Ivory reads as paper and bone. It is cooler, it is older, and it does not share a temperature with the materials, which are amber, brown and green.

02

The object is shown. The person is not.

A face on a surface is a face the viewer is invited to become. The house sells the opposite. Photograph the bottle, the material, the register and the hands at work. Never a model.

03

Typography carries it. Ornament does not exist.

No crests, no monograms in wreaths, no gold foil flourishes, no serif drop caps. The weight comes from the type, the space around it and the paper. Ornament is what a house adds when it does not trust the first three.

04

One accent per surface

A page, a label or a screen carries one coloured element and no more. An accent that appears twice has become a pattern, and a pattern is decoration.

05

Everything is numbered and dated

Formula number, harvest year, composition date, bottle count. The monospaced layer running through the identity is the house's honesty made visible, and it is the visual form of belief three.

What these five rule out, immediately

- NO** Black and gold. The category default, and it says money rather than attention.
- NO** A soft-focus photograph of a woman with her eyes closed.
- NO** Botanical illustration. It belongs to the Innocent, which page 17 forbids.
- NO** A wax seal, a crest, a rope-bound scroll. The house is being founded now and should not pretend to have been founded in 1780.
- NO** Gradients, glass, soft shadow. The visual language of software, applied to an object that has weight.

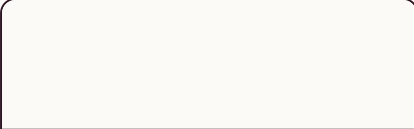
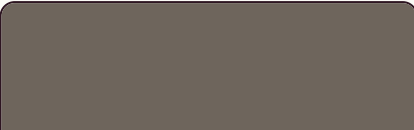
The reference that is closest

Not another perfume house. A gallery's condition report, or the label on the back of a painting: ivory card, a number, a date, a name, set small, in a typeface chosen for reading rather than for atmosphere.

That reference holds the Magician and the Lover at once, and no one in this category is using it.

Six colours, *six roles*.

A colour without a role becomes decoration, then becomes an inconsistency. Each value below has one use and no other. No further colour enters the system, and the two dark variants at the foot of the page are tools rather than brand colours.

 Ivoire #FBFAF6 The default surface, and roughly eighty per cent of everything. Ivory rather than cream: paper and bone, not oat and sand. It is the single decision that separates this house from the natural category at fifty paces.	 Encre #201A16 Text, rules, the wordmark. A resinous brown-black, the colour of an aged absolute in the bottle. Never a pure black, which would be colder than any material in the house.	 Craie #FFFFFF Reserved white. The label, the formula card, the register line. Only ever the surfaces that carry evidence, which turns white into a signal instead of a background.
 Vétiver #4E5C4A The material side. Origin, season, provenance, the sourcing line. A green that has been in a bottle rather than on a leaf.	 Grenat #6E2B3A The Lover's single accent. One per surface, no more. Used where the house addresses one person directly, and nowhere else.	 Cendre #6E655C Secondary text, captions, metadata. It replaces neutral grey, which does not exist in this system.

Measured, not assumed

Ratios calculated by the standard accessibility method. Thresholds: 4.5 for body text, 3.0 for large display and non-text elements. The rule column is what each pair is permitted to do, and it is not a recommendation.

PAIR	RATIO	PERMITTED USE
Encre on Ivoire	16.47	Everything. The default.
Encre on Craie	17.20	Everything. Evidence surfaces.
Grenat on Ivoire	9.72	Body text, headings, the accent.
Vétiver foncé #3A4637 on Ivoire	9.52	Body text, headings.
Vétiver on Ivoire	6.81	Body text at 15px and above.
Laiton foncé #7C6224 on Ivoire	5.54	Body text. The only way brass reaches type.
Cendre on Ivoire	5.47	Secondary text. Never under 15px.
Laiton on Ivoire	3.30	Large display and non-text only. No body copy, ever.
Laiton on Encre	4.99	Text on the dark surface.

The seventh, which is not a colour

 Laiton • #A8853F

Brass. It exists as a material, not as an ink: the cap, the stamp, the edge of a card. On screen it is a simulation of something physical and it should be used as sparingly as the metal would be.

At 3.30 it cannot legally carry body text, which is convenient, because it should never have been asked to.

Proportions

Ivoire 82. Encre 12. Cendre 3. Vétiver 2. Grenat 0.7. Laiton 0.3.

Deliberately unbalanced. An accent occupying more than one per cent of a surface has stopped being an accent, which is principle four on page 28 expressed as a number.

Three families. *One job each.*

All three are licensed for any use at no cost, which matters for a house that will print, web, embroider and engrave before it has a design retainer. The specimens below are set in the actual faces.

Display • large only

Instrument *Serif*

One weight and its italic. High contrast, a little sharp, contemporary rather than revived. It has the authority of a title page without the couture signal a Bodoni would carry.

Why. The category reaches for a didone, which says Paris, 1955 and a fashion house. This house is neither. The italic carries the Lover and is the only emphasis the system has, since there is no bold.

Rule: 24px and above. Never body text. Alternatives if it fails: Newsreader, Spectral, EB Garamond.

Text and interface

Instrument Sans

A neo-grotesque with slightly narrowed forms, drawn by the same foundry as the display face, which is why the pair sits without argument. This paragraph is set in it.

Rules. 16px minimum anywhere a client reads. 18px on the pages that explain a commission. Line length 60 to 72 characters. Leading 1.55.

Alternatives: Inter, Public Sans.

Evidence layer

Geist Mono

FORMULA 0041 • 19 MATERIALS
COMPOSED 14 MARCH 2027
IRIS PALLIDA • TUSCANY • 2022

The monospace carries everything that proves something: numbers, dates, origins, harvest years, batch references, table headings. It is the laboratory register inside the identity, and principle five on page 28 depends on it existing.

Rule. Tabular figures always. A column of numbers that does not align destroys a document's credibility faster than an error in it.

The hierarchy

LEVEL	FAMILY	TREATMENT
Section label	Geist Mono	Upper case, wide letterspacing, small, in Cendre.
Statement	Instrument Serif	Large, tight leading, italic for the single emphasised phrase.
Heading	Instrument Serif	Sentence case always. Title case belongs to another century of this category.
Body	Instrument Sans	Regular. Medium for the one phrase that carries the sentence. Bold does not appear.
Caption, data, label	Geist Mono	Small, tabular, Cendre or Vétiver.
Object engraving	Geist Mono	Upper case. The formula number and nothing else.

The wordmark, once the name exists

Set in the display face, lower case, at its natural spacing, with no modification beyond optical correction of the first and last pair.

No custom drawing, no ligature invented for the purpose, no monogram. A house whose mark is its name set well is confident. A house that draws a symbol is asking to be recognised before it has been remembered.

Section IV settles the name. The mark follows in one afternoon after that.

Layout, *and the one device the house owns.*

The system needs exactly one recognisable move. Everything else should be restraint, because restraint is not ownable and does not need to be. The device proposed here is a hairline, and it is running down the outer edge of this page.

The trail

A single hairline, set at a fixed distance from the outer edge, running the full height of every surface. It carries one mark, and the mark sits at the vertical position of something true.

SURFACE	WHAT THE MARK REPORTS
A printed document	Position in the document. Page eight of forty-four sits at eight forty-fourths down.
The website	Scroll position, moving as the reader moves. No numbers, no percentage.
A commission's papers	Stage. Reading, sourcing, trials, composition, delivery. Five positions.
The label	Nothing. The mark is at the top and stays there. On the object the trail is an ornament, and it is the only one permitted.

Why it works. Sillage is the trail a scent leaves behind a person: the technical term, not a metaphor. A line with one mark on it is the simplest drawing of that, it costs nothing to reproduce at any size, it survives being embossed, engraved or set in a single CSS rule, and no house in this category is using it.

Why it is honest. The mark always reports a real position. A device that means nothing becomes decoration within a year, and principle three on page 28 has already thrown ornament out.

The grid

- Twelve columns on screen, six in print, three on a label.
- The outer margin is never smaller than four times the cap height of the display face at its size on that surface. On a label that leaves an uncomfortable amount of space. Leave it.
- Text sets to the left. Centred type appears once, on the label, and nowhere else.
- One statement per surface. If a page has two things to say, it is two pages.

The rhythm of a page

Label in mono, statement in the serif, body in the sans, evidence in mono again. Four bands, in that order, on every surface from a business card to a contract.

It is the same rhythm the document you are holding uses, which is the cheapest possible way to check that a system works before committing to it.

What to build first

The label, not the website. The label is the hardest constraint in the system, and anything that survives it will survive a screen. A system designed on a screen and then squeezed onto a 40mm label fails at the last step, which is the step the client actually holds.

The object. *One bottle, one card, one box.*

A house that makes one thing per client should make one object, extremely well, and resist every opportunity to extend it. The whole physical system is three items, and two of them are paper.



The flacon

Heavy, flat-shouldered, clear glass. Clear because the liquid of a natural composition is a colour nobody chose: amber, olive, occasionally almost black. That colour is evidence, and coloured glass would hide the one part of the object the house did not design.

Brass cap, unlacquered, so it marks with handling. An object that records having been used belongs to the person using it. A lacquered cap that stays perfect belongs to the shop.

One size. No travel bottle, no discovery set, no smaller format at a lower price. Page 17 named the drift and this is where it would start.

The label

Craie white, the only reserved white in the system. Three lines in mono, centred, which is the single centred setting the house permits. The formula number, the client's name as she gives it, and the date of composition in roman numerals for the month, because a date that has to be read slowly is read.

Nothing describes the contents. No notes, no family, no adjective. The person wearing it knows what is in it, and nobody else is entitled to.

The box

Ivory board, uncoated, blind-embossed with the wordmark on the base rather than the lid. A client finds it when she turns the box over, which is a small private moment and exactly the register of the Lover.

Inside, the bottle and the card. Nothing else. No tissue, no ribbon, no card thanking her for her order.

The card

The formula card, page 35. It is the second most important object the house makes and it costs the price of a sheet of paper.

What is not made

- NO Candle, diffuser, soap, body oil, linen spray.
- NO A house fragrance sold in a bottle.
- NO Branded tote, notebook, card holder.
- NO A second bottle in a smaller size.

Each one is profitable. Each one converts a maison into a lifestyle brand, which page 20 refuses.

What is photographed, *and what never is.*

Principle two on page 28 says the object is shown and the person is not. That single rule removes ninety per cent of the images this category produces, and what is left is more interesting than what was removed.

Photograph

- YES** **The material, as it arrives.** Root, resin, dried peel, a jar with a producer's handwriting on it. This is the house's best image category and nobody else can shoot it, because nobody else buys this way.
- YES** **The bench.** Bottles at the working scale, a scale, a pipette, a stained notebook. Untied. A photographed bench that has been styled is a photograph of a set.
- YES** **Hands.** Françoise's hands, at work, doing a thing that is actually happening. Hands are the one part of a person the house may show, because they are doing rather than being.
- YES** **The object.** One bottle, flat light, on ivory, at its actual size.
- YES** **Paper.** The card, the register, the envelope. Photographed as documents are photographed in an archive: square on, evenly lit, no atmosphere.

Never photograph

- NO** **A model.** Any face. A face is an instruction to become someone, and the house exists to say the opposite.
- NO** **A client, or a client's bottle.** Even with permission, even beautifully. Page 21 makes this an absolute.
- NO** **A field of lavender at golden hour.** The stock image of the entire natural category. It shows a crop the house may not even buy.
- NO** **Liquid pouring, splashing, or suspended in air.** Advertising language from the 1990s, and it wastes a material that cost money.
- NO** **Anything generated.** The house sells the claim that a person paid attention. A generated image is proof that nobody did, and one of them appearing in a feed would undo more than it saves.

The treatment

LIGHT	One source, daylight, from the side. Never a beauty light, never a ring, never a coloured gel. Shadows are allowed to be dark and are not filled.
COLOUR	Shot on ivory or on the surface the thing actually sits on. No colour grade. Naturals are brown, amber and green, and those colours are the point.
FRAMING	Square on, or straight down. No tilted three-quarter product angle. The reference is a catalogue, not a campaign.
CROP	Generous. The object small inside the frame, with the space around it left empty, matching the margin rule on page 31.
MOTION	Rare, long, and fixed. A locked camera on a process that takes time. Nothing cuts faster than the thing being filmed.

The one image the house needs first

Not the bottle. A single material, photographed with its label, its origin and its year set beside it in mono.

It states the entire proposition in one frame: this house knows where things come from, and will tell you. It costs an afternoon, and it can be repeated for every material in the cabinet, which gives the house a library nobody can copy without buying the same materials.

The one formula *that repeats.*

A perfume house that never smells of anything is a strange object. The resolution is already in the platform: the house is itself a subject, it can be read like any other, and it gets one formula. That formula repeats because there is one house, and it is never sold.

Where it appears, and where it must not

APPEARS ON	AT WHAT STRENGTH
The outer shipping sleeve	Perceptible on opening the courier box, gone within a week. The client meets the house before she meets her own bottle.
The atelier and the room where readings happen	Low, and switched off before a reading begins. A nose cannot read a person through the house's own accord.
The dinner, page 24	On the linen and nowhere else.
Correspondence on paper	Trace. Enough that an envelope is recognised before it is opened.

The technical rule that is easy to get wrong

The accord never touches the inner box, the card or anything in contact with the flacon. A scented presentation box competing with the composition inside it is a genuine error, not a matter of taste: the client's first impression of her own formula would be of two perfumes arguing.

Outer sleeve yes. Inner box no. Write it into the packaging specification, because it is the kind of instruction that gets lost between a designer and a converter.

What it should be made of

A direction for Françoise, not a formula. The brief is that the accord should behave like the brand rather than describe it.

- **Orris at the centre.** The most patient material in perfumery: rhizomes dried for years before they are worth anything. Cool, powdery, faintly ivory. It is the palette on page 29 in olfactive form, and its cost is the point.
- **Vetiver beneath it.** The trail, in the literal sense. Dry, rooted, long.
- **A resin to close it.** Labdanum or benzoin, dark and slightly sticky. The Encre of the composition.

Cool, not warm. Dry, not sweet. Every house at this price reaches for warmth, because warmth is welcoming. This one should be recognisably restrained, in the same way its surface is ivory rather than cream.

Three things it is not

- NO** Not a product. It is never bottled or sold, at any price, to anyone.
- NO** Not named in copy. It is recognised, not announced.
- NO** Not a base. No client formula is built on it. Every commission starts from nothing.

THIS PAGE SETTLES that the house has one accord, that it repeats, and that it is never sold.

The card. *The promise, on one sheet of paper.*

Three beliefs, one promise and one rule from this platform have to become an object or they stay opinions. This is that object. It ships inside the box, it costs almost nothing, and it is the single most valuable thing the house produces after the perfume itself.

FORMULE

0041

Marguerite L.

LECTURE

Paris, 9 & 10 janvier 2027

TÊTE

Bergamote · Calabre · 2026

Élémi · Philippines · 2025

11%

3%

CŒUR

Iris pallida · Toscane · 2022

Rose de mai · Grasse · 2026

Osmanthus · Guilin · 2024

9%

6%

2%

FOND

Vétiver · Haïti · 2023

Labdanum · Andalousie · 2024

Benjoin · Siam · 2023

14%

8%

5%

+ 11

matières, liste complète au verso

19 MATIÈRES · COMPOSÉE LE 14 MARS 2027 · CLOSE LE 14 MARS 2027

CONTIENT LIMONÈNE, LINALOL, GÉRANIOL · DÉCLARATION AU VERSO

F. RAPP

What every element on it is doing

ELEMENT	WHICH PART OF THE PLATFORM IT PROVES
The number	The register on page 23. It is quotable, sequential, and it means the client can be told exactly how many formulas preceded hers.
Her name, set large	The essence on page 16. A portrait carries the sitter's name, not the painter's title.
The dates of the reading	Anchor two and belief four. The reading happened, on days that can be named.
Material, origin, year	Belief three, in its only verifiable form. This is the column no other house at any price publishes.
The proportions	Anchor three, held deliberately. Enough to prove the composition exists, not enough to reproduce it.
Closed on the same day	The one-bottle rule, page 23. The formula left the palette the day it was finished.
The allergen line	Belief six. Naturals carry allergens, the house says so plainly and does not hide it in a leaflet.
The signature	One person made this and is accountable for it. Printed signatures are not permitted. It is signed by hand or it is not on the card.

Why the card matters more than the website

It is the only object in the system that a client will show to someone else unprompted. It is small, it is beautiful, it contains a name and a set of places, and it says something about its owner that she would not say herself.

Door one on page 22 is the whole acquisition strategy of this house, and this card is the thing that actually opens it. Budget for it accordingly: letterpress or engraved, on the same ivory board as the box, and never reprinted for a client who lost hers without the register being checked first.

Written in French, read anywhere

The card stays in French regardless of the client's language, and the reverse carries the English. Material names, origins and the structure of a composition are French by convention in this craft, and translating them on the front would trade precision for convenience.

Voice mechanics, page 26.

Eight criteria, *agreed before any name is looked at.*

The name was never raised in the session. That is not a gap, it is the correct order: a name chosen before the platform describes a mood, and a name chosen after it describes a house. The criteria come first, and they come from Sections II and III.

THE CRITERION	WHERE IT COMES FROM
01 It says nothing about what is in the bottle.	The house composes nineteen different things a year. A name that describes a scent will be wrong nineteen times.
02 It survives a telephone.	Said aloud by a concierge in Paris, in Dubai and in New York, and spelled correctly by the person who hears it. Door two, page 22.
03 It works in French and in English without changing its mouth.	One founder is French, the other is not, and the clientele is neither.
04 It holds the Magician and the Lover, or it holds neither and lets the work do it.	Page 17. A name that carries only one of the two will pull the house toward that half.
05 It has room above it.	The establishment line and the club both sit under it. A name that means <i>a perfume for you</i> cannot hold a hotel.
06 It contains no category word.	No parfum, scent, essence, aroma, olfactive, nose. All are taken, all are generic, and all are unregistrable on their own.
07 It reads correctly in lower case, in the display face.	Page 30. The wordmark is the name set well and nothing else, so the name has to be able to carry that.
08 It does not need explaining in the first sentence.	A name whose meaning has to be taught is a name the house will spend a decade apologising for.

Three routes the criteria leave open

- 01 **The founders' names.** The category's own tradition and the shortest route to credibility, because a portrait is signed. Pages 37 and 39.
- 02 **A material or a method.** A word from the craft that carries the house's temperament rather than its output. Page 37.
- 03 **A word from the platform.** Something taken from the logic on pages 16 and 23 rather than from perfumery at all. Page 38.

Nine names follow, scored against the eight criteria. None is proposed as a favourite before the scoring, which is the point of writing the criteria down first.

Read this before page 37

No trademark search has been run. Not on any of the nine, not in class 3, not in any jurisdiction. Everything in this section is a strategic recommendation and nothing in it is a clearance.

If a name already exists for this house, and was simply not raised on 18 September, it wins. This section then becomes the naming reservoir for the objects on page 39, which is a useful outcome rather than a wasted one.

Five routes. *The founders, and the craft.*

Each route is scored against the eight criteria from page 36, in order. A filled mark is a pass, an amber mark is a pass with a condition, an open mark is a failure. Nothing here has been cleared for use.

Route 01 · the founders

Rapp



The nose's surname, alone or as Maison Rapp. It is the tradition of the craft: Guerlain, Creed, Kurkdjian. A portrait is signed, and this signs it.

Against. It names one of two founders. The session ruled that a house has one soul, and a name carrying one founder places the other outside her own house on every label the company will ever print. Anna supplied the ambition, the refusals and the client definition.

Condition on 5: a personal surname carries an establishment line comfortably and sits awkwardly over a club.

Route 02 · the founders

Esen & Rapp



Both surnames, in the manner of an atelier or a practice rather than a fashion house. It fixes what route 01 breaks, and it keeps everything route 01 wins.

For. It cannot be invented, guessed or generated. It is signed by both people who made it. It is identical in French and English. It ages the way a house should, because practices outlive their founders and everyone understands that convention already.

Against. Long on a 40mm label, and the ampersand needs deliberate setting in the display face. If one founder leaves, the name does not.

Condition on 2: test it aloud on a telephone in three accents before committing.

Route 03 · the craft

Orris



The iris rhizome, dried for three to five years before it is worth anything. The most patient and most expensive material in the cabinet, and the centre of the house accord on page 34. Cool, powdery, faintly ivory: the palette in olfactive form.

Against. It names a material, which criterion 1 rules out, and a client will reasonably expect to smell it in her own formula. It is also a word this category reaches for often.

The strongest of the routes that are not the founders' names.

Route 04 · the craft

Enfleurage



The cold-fat method: a living flower laid on grease for weeks, giving up its scent without heat and without being crushed. Capture without force. As a metaphor for the entire platform it is close to perfect, and it carries the Magician and the Explorer at once.

Against. Four syllables, a French mouth, and it will be misspelled by everyone who hears it before they see it. Criterion 8 is fatal: it needs a sentence of explanation, every time, forever.

Route 05 · the craft

Alambic



The still. The copper vessel in which one thing is turned into another, which is the Magician made physical rather than mystical. Concrete, old, unpretentious, and it sets well in lower case.

Against. It belongs to distillers before it belongs to perfumers, and the spirits industry has been using it for two centuries. Expect a crowded register and an awkward conversation with anyone who makes eau de vie. It also reads slightly industrial for a house whose central act is listening to a person.

Four more. *The platform, and the obvious one.*

Route 06 • the craft

Sillage



The trail a scent leaves behind a person as she passes. It is the most beautiful word this craft owns, it is already the identity's one device on page 31, and it describes a person being perceived after she has gone, which is close to the essence.

Against. Every perfumer reaches for it, and several have arrived already. Treat criterion 6 as failed in spirit if not in letter: it is a category word, and to anyone inside the category it will read as the first idea rather than the chosen one.

Worth keeping. Page 39 puts it to better use.

Route 07 • the platform

Le Fond



The base note, the part of a composition that is still there eight hours later. In French the word also means the bottom, the substance, the thing underneath. Two meanings, one word, and both are the platform.

Against. In English it reads as *fund* or as *fond*, and neither is recoverable. The definite article makes it awkward in every sentence a non-French speaker will try to build around it.

Route 08 • the platform

The Sitter



The person who sits for a portrait. It is the essence on page 16 made literal, it is unused in this category, and it puts the client at the centre of the name rather than the house, which no competitor does.

Against. English only, and criterion 3 is not negotiable for a house with a French nose and an international clientele. In English the word also carries a domestic association that a single unfortunate headline would make permanent.

Route 09 • the platform

Portrait



The essence, undisguised, and identical in French and English. It needs no explanation at all, which is rare.

Against. It is a common noun in two languages. It is close to unregistrable on its own, it will never rank in search, and a client will spend the rest of her life saying *no, the perfume one*.

What the scoring shows

Two patterns, and both were predictable once the criteria were written down first, which is the argument for writing them down first.

- **Every name taken from perfumery fails criterion 1 or 6.** Orris, Enfleurage, Sillage and Alambic each describe the craft, and the craft is not what this house sells. It sells attention paid to a person.
- **Every name taken from the platform fails criterion 3.** Le Fond, The Sitter and Portrait are each trapped in one language or in the public domain. The ideas are right and the words are not available.
- **Only the founders' names pass on both axes,** because a surname describes nothing and therefore contradicts nothing, and because a signature is the one form of proof this house already uses on the card, in the register and on the bottle.

A warning about elimination

A name that survives eight criteria is not thereby the right name. Criteria remove the wrong answers, they do not produce the right one.

The last step belongs to the two of you, said aloud, in a room, several times, to somebody who does not know what it is for.

The recommendation, *and what else has to be named.*

Recommended

esen & rapp

Set lower case in the display face, as page 30 requires. The ampersand is the only drawn element in the identity and it earns that place, because it is the part of the name that says there are two of you.

The argument in one line. This house sells the claim that a specific person paid attention to a specific person. A name that is those people is the shortest possible proof of that claim, and it is the only route that cannot be arrived at by anyone reasoning about the category from outside.

It also solves the one problem the session flagged. Nizzar ruled that a house has one soul with many expressions. Route 01 would have given the soul one owner. This gives it two, which is what it has.

The alternative, if you do not want your names on it

Take **Orris**, and accept the cost of criterion 1 deliberately rather than by accident. If you do, the house should never use orris as the lead material in a client formula, so that the name stays a temperament rather than becoming a promise about contents.

That is a real constraint on Françoise's palette for the life of the brand. Decide it with her, not around her.

Before anything is printed

- 01 Trademark search, class 3, in every market you intend to sell into. None has been run.
- 02 Domain, and the two nearest misspellings.
- 03 Say it to ten people who know nothing about this, and ask them to spell it back.
- 04 Check what it means in Arabic, Turkish and German. Two of the three are in your own network.

If a name already exists

If the house is already called something, and it simply did not come up on 18 September, that name wins without argument. This section then becomes a reservoir, and the table below is where its contents go.

What else has to be named, and where those names come from

THE OBJECT	PROPOSED	WHY, AND THE RULE IT HAS TO OBEY
The club	Le Fond	Those who share the base. Route 07 failed as a house name because it is trapped in French. A private room whose members are half French is exactly where that stops being a problem. It is never printed in a proposal. Page 24.
The house accord	Sillage	Route 06 was too obvious for the house and is exactly right for the thing that is its trail. Never sold, never named in copy. Page 34.
The establishment line	Alambic	Route 05 reads industrial for a house and correct for a line that composes for buildings. Door two, page 22.
The register	Le Registre	Plain, and it should stay plain. The object on page 23 derives its authority from sounding like an accounting document rather than a relic.
The card	La Fiche	Page 35. Same reasoning. A fiche is what a laboratory produces, and that is the register the card is borrowing.
The commission itself	La Lecture	The reading. It names the expensive part rather than the liquid, which is the whole pricing argument on page 23 compressed into one word a client will repeat.

OPEN the house name. Decision 03 on page 44. The six object names above are proposals.

The offer, *read as an expression of the brand.*

A commercial frame does not exist yet, and this page is not one. It is the shape the offer has to have for the platform to be true, with the numbers left as brackets for you to fill. Where a number is written, it is an illustration and it is marked.

The commission

La Lecture

What is bought. A reading with Françoise. Not a fragrance. The distinction is the pricing argument and it has to survive being said out loud on the telephone.

What it contains. The sitting. The sourcing, including materials bought for the first time. Three to six trials. The composition. One bottle, the card, and the line in the register.

Priced for the reading, not for the liquid. That is why the number does not change with the size of the bottle, and why it is the same for a difficult client as for an easy one.

The relationship

The refill

What is bought. The same formula, remade. Page 23 explains why this is not a breach of the promise but the proof of it.

Priced for the liquid. Materials and labour. The expensive part was paid for once and is never charged again, and saying so plainly is more persuasive than any loyalty scheme the house could invent.

One message, no reconsultation, no upsell. This should be the easiest transaction in the business. Every friction added to it is a tax on the house's best revenue.

The second line

Alambic

What is bought. A composition read from a building rather than from a person. Hotels were the example named in the session.

Why it belongs. It passes the three-question test on page 20: read from one subject, made once, signed by the nose. A candle does not. A hotel does.

Never quoted per litre. The reading is priced, the diffusion is supplied at cost plus, and the contract renews annually or the house stops supplying.

The service rules, which are where presence went

Anna proposed *present* as a culture word and Françoise correctly said it was a state of being rather than a description. Page 10 promised it would come back here. These six rules are that word turned into things the house does.

- 01 **The reading is not interrupted.** No telephone in the room, no second appointment that day, no fixed end time. A sitting that ran over is a sitting that worked.
- 02 **The house accord is off** before a client arrives. Page 34. A nose cannot read a person through her own house.
- 03 **Nothing is proposed in the first hour.** Page 07. The client is listened to for longer than is comfortable, and the discomfort is the product.
- 04 **One working day, always.** Including when the answer is not ready. *I do not know yet, I will know on Thursday* is an answer.
- 05 **Sourcing costs are returned** if a commission is abandoned after materials were bought. The house keeps the materials, which it would have bought anyway for the reason on page 08.
- 06 **The nose signs.** By hand, on the card. If Françoise did not compose it, it does not ship.

The number that has to be true

Capacity. How many commissions can Françoise compose in a year while rule one holds? Whatever that number is, it is the house's only honest form of scarcity and the only one page 21 permits.

Publish it as a production fact and never as a marketing device. *She composes eleven a year* is persuasive because it is checkable and because it is obviously a limit rather than a tactic.

Eleven is an illustration used throughout this document. Replace it with the real number before anything is published. Decision 05, page 44.

Eight numbers. *None of them is reach.*

A house with eleven clients a year cannot be run on the instruments the marketing industry sells. Every number below can be counted by hand in an afternoon, and each one checks a specific claim made earlier in this document.

MEASURE	READS WELL AT	WHAT IT CHECKS, AND WHERE THE CLAIM WAS MADE
Share of commissions from door one	Above 70% by year two	That referral is the channel, and that no acquisition programme is needed. Page 22.
Refill rate at eighteen months	Above 60%	The commercial engine on page 23. A low rate means the reading was wrong, not that the client moved on.
Trials per commission	Falling, year on year	That the nose's reading is improving. A flat line over three years means the process has stopped learning.
Weeks from first contact to the sitting	Long, and published	Capacity as a production fact. Page 40. If it is short, the house is not at capacity and should say so rather than pretend.
Establishment contracts renewed	Above 80%	Door two. A hotel that does not renew was sold an amenity, which means the reframe on page 22 failed.
Hours worked per person per week	Falling as revenue rises	The efficiency value, page 19, and the only external audit of it. Both numbers rising together means the value has been abandoned.
Refusals recorded	More than zero, every quarter	Page 21. A quarter with no written refusals means nothing was tested, or that something was accepted and not written down.
Guests brought to a dinner by a member	Rising, unprompted	Door four, page 24. It is the only signal the club is working, and it must never be solicited.

What the house deliberately does not measure

NO	Followers, impressions, reach, engagement.	The house sells eleven things a year to people who are not reached by advertising. Measuring an audience it does not need will, eventually, cause it to build one.
NO	Email list size.	The same failure with a longer delay.
NO	Press mentions.	Pleasant. Not a signal. Page 18 already names the trend-piece trap under the visionary value.
NO	Conversion rate on the site.	There is no conversion on the site. There is an enquiry, and then there is a person.

Each of these becomes tempting in a slow quarter, and each is a proxy for the thing that is actually slow. The eight numbers above tell you which one.

The one to read first

The refill rate. It is the only number that reports on the quality of the reading rather than on the quality of the selling, and the reading is the whole product.

A client who does not come back for a second bottle of her own perfume was not read correctly. That is uncomfortable, it is unambiguous, and it is worth more than every other number on this page put together.

Ninety days. *Label first, website last.*

The order matters more than the speed. Page 31 says the label is the hardest constraint in the system and anything that survives it survives a screen. A house that builds its website first will design a system that fails at 40 millimetres, which is the size the client actually holds.

DAYS	WHAT IS DONE	OWNER	WHY IT COMES HERE AND NOT LATER
01 • 30	Close the five decisions on page 44.	Both	Nothing downstream can be built on brackets. This is one afternoon, not a project.
	Set the real capacity number.	Françoise	It sets the price, the waiting time and the scarcity language. Everything commercial waits on it.
	Trademark search, class 3.	Anna	Before a single thing is printed. Page 39.
	Open the register and the refusal log.	Both	Both are cheap now and impossible to reconstruct later. The register has to start at the first commission or its numbering is a fiction.
	Write the packaging note about the accord.	Françoise	Page 34. Outer sleeve yes, inner box no. It gets lost between a designer and a converter if it is not written down first.
31 • 60	The name lands. The wordmark is set.	Both	An afternoon of typesetting once the name exists, per page 30. Nothing is drawn.
	The label is designed and printed.	Anna	The first real test of the whole system. If the label works, the rest follows from it.
	The card is specified and proofed.	Both	Page 35. The most valuable object after the perfume, and it needs a hand signature, which means a real proof on real board.
	The material photography begins.	Françoise	One material, one afternoon, repeated. The library compounds and no competitor can copy it without buying the same materials.
61 • 90	One page. Not a website.	Anna	The house sells eleven things a year through referral. A single page that states the proposition and opens an enquiry is the correct size.
	The first dinner. Eight people.	Both	Page 24. The cheapest version of the club that is still true, and the only honest way to find out whether it exists.
	One establishment conversation.	Anna	Door two. Not to close it, to find out whether the reframe on page 22 holds when someone asks for a price per litre.
	Write the commercial frame.	Both	Prices, formulas, terms, capacity. The companion to this document, and it can only be written once the decisions above are closed.

What is deliberately not in the first ninety days

No social accounts. No press. No launch. No investor conversation. No brand film. Each of those is an answer to the question *how do we become known*, and this house does not have that question yet. It has eleven slots and a referral mechanism, and both are on page 22.

If the first three commissions arrive and each one brings a referral, the house has proved its model and can spend the second ninety days on anything it likes. If they do not, nothing on that list would have helped.

The single gate

Do not print the label until the name is cleared, and do not clear the name until the five decisions are closed.

Everything else on this page can run in any order or slip by a month without cost. That one sequence cannot.

The verbatims, *in the order they were said.*

Every claim in this document traces to one of these. Time codes are from the recording of 18 September 2026. Spelling is lightly cleaned and nothing is paraphrased. Words the house has since banned appear here as they were spoken.

TIME	SAID	TIME	SAID
00:06:32 Nizzar p04	The first exercise was more free. You had the feeling that you were in control. That wasn't the case, but I gave you the feeling that you were in control.	00:45:00 Anna p09	The uniqueness of every individual being a part of the company, and bringing their uniqueness on the table.
00:07:34 Anna p04	We are having a business meeting and three of us is doing coffee. It shows the trust and how comfortable we feel. That's how business should be done.	00:47:08 Nizzar p10	It is already implied. So it is a waste of an adjective.
00:09:04 Nizzar p06	It is not a matter of taste. It is a matter of alignment.	00:47:46 Anna p09	The more efficient we are, the more space and time we create. They can be done the work in ten hours.
00:15:11 Françoise p07	Believing in this power of transformation, that you can become. That translates what the power of perfume can be and what we can do with it.	00:49:25 Françoise p10	The fact that you have a vision, and the uniqueness, the mix of both tends to be cutting edge.
00:15:53 Françoise p07	Quality is remembered long after the price is forgotten. It could have been our tagline.	00:52:08 Françoise p10	I don't know if people would talk about the company like that. For me that is a state of being.
00:17:27 Françoise p08	We work with nature. Connected to the nature of botanics, but also the nature of human being. Climate change can affect my work. It is interconnected.	00:53:56 Nizzar p09	It is a mix of I take responsibility and I take action in responsibility.
00:19:19 Françoise p08	As a perfumer I feel like an explorer. I am going to order ingredients that I don't know, that I haven't worked with.	00:55:51 Nizzar p09	It doesn't make sense to hire smart people and then tell them what to do. We hire smart people so they tell us what to do.
00:19:47 Nizzar p04	By pushing, you get something that was completely outside my spectrum. It widens the possibilities for how we position ourselves.	00:58:00 Anna p11	My ideal clients are people who are standing already where they can influence the world.
00:21:08 Anna p07	You say to yourself, I love myself enough to create something that expresses my essence. To buy it for yourself, you need to love yourself a lot.	00:59:12 Françoise p11	Passionate. They have a drive. They can be passionate about art, or work, or their charity thing.
00:21:08 Anna p07	See the magic. See behind the veil. We stopped so much to see the magic.	01:00:06 Anna p11	We need something that grounds them, because influential and passionate can turn into disruptive power.
00:27:23 Anna p08 • 24	The club, where the people connect, after you have your fragrance. Come with your most exciting part of you, this childish version of willing to create.	01:01:30 Anna p11	Bill Gates is intelligent, but with the influence and the passion, he can destroy.
00:28:14 Nizzar p02 • 24	You can have different expressions, but you have only one soul. The fragrance is the entry to the club, but the club is not the subject, it is the impact.	01:04:28 Nizzar p11 • 22	It is easier to go down the peak of the mountain than to climb it. These people, they will make the others follow.
00:41:13 Françoise p09	Maybe it's supportive then. We are creating a supportive environment for our team to grow, to expand, like our clients.	01:06:34 Françoise p11	I would put wealthy, because we want people to have the money to buy our products.
00:40:10 Anna p10	A woman doesn't need to be empowered. We have been sold the story of empowering as if we don't carry the power within ourselves.	The available recording ends at 01:06:49, during the discussion of the fifth client adjective. One entry on the archetype board, the Caregiver, is not legible in the recording, and its brand name is recorded as unknown on page 06.	

Five decisions. *All of them yours.*

Everything else in this document is settled, derived or proposed with its reasoning exposed. These five cannot be settled by a strategist, because each one is a preference, a constraint or a fact only the two of you hold.

	THE DECISION	WHAT IS RECOMMENDED	WHAT IT UNBLOCKS
01	The fifth client adjective. page 11	Self-possessed. It is the client-side of the word the culture exercise refused. Alternates: private, exacting.	The client profile, which every piece of writing and every refusal is calibrated against.
02	Voice and visual direction. pages 25 to 35	Accept as written, amend in place, or re-run the two exercises the session did not reach and rebuild Section III from your own words.	Everything in the ninety days. Nothing can be designed while eleven pages are marked as proposals.
03	The name. pages 36 to 39	esen & rapp , lower case, in the display face. Alternative: Orris, with the palette constraint attached. An existing name, if one exists, overrides both.	The wordmark, the label, the domain, the trademark filing, and the bracket in the positioning paragraph on page 16.
04	What happens to a formula when its owner dies. page 23	It passes with the estate and can be refilled by whoever holds it. It is still never composed for anyone else.	The terms of a commission, and a conversation that will otherwise happen for the first time in the worst possible circumstances.
05	The real annual capacity. page 40	Whatever Françoise can compose while the reading is never interrupted. Eleven is an illustration used throughout this document and is almost certainly wrong.	The price, the waiting time, and the only form of scarcity page 21 permits.

What happens after they are closed

The platform is signed and stops moving. Observe and Collapse are then finished, and The Collapse moves to Build: the name, the mark, the label, the card, the one page, the commercial frame. Hold begins at the first commission and is a quarterly conversation against this document, not against the market.

The test of whether this was worth doing is not whether you like it. It is whether, in eighteen months, one of you refuses something profitable and can point at a page number.

We accepted at every challenge where the brand wanted to go, and we just followed it, because we knew we had created something with strength that would outlast us.

THE FIVE-YEAR FRAME, AS IT WAS PUT TO BOTH FOUNDERS ·
00:31:25

The one thing to protect

Not the name, not the palette, not the club.

The sentence three separate exercises arrived at independently, on page 12: **do not add anything to the person.**

Every other decision in this document can be reversed without damage. That one is the house. It is also the only thing here that the category makes it expensive to keep.

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Observe, Collapse, Build, Hold
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